

Advanced Studio | ARCH 420/546



Building: Inside Studio Gang Architects, Art Institute of Chicago, 2013

The Architecture of Exhibitions and Installations

Understanding Architecture through Exhibitions and Installations

“To exhibit is to find friends and allies for the struggle.” Edouard Manet, 1867

At the end of each year at IIT, the College of Architecture host a display of the yearlong work of students studying architecture with an audience that encompasses students, families of students, faculty, staff, alumni, architectural enthusiast and the larger public. Thus, being given the name, Open House, as an exhibit where all are welcome. The curation of work for Open House is an opportunity to comprehensively showcase the results of each degree program in the College of Architecture, and the curation of work also is an opportunity to frame the narrative or agendas that the school has tackled through the study of architecture. Our seminar will seek to become the curatorial team for this year's IIT Open House.

This studio will study two parallel paths. One path will be uncovering the history and current context of art and architecture exhibitions through text and discussions with curators and exhibitors of biennials and museums. The second path will explore curation firsthand through the design, management and fabrication of this year's IIT CoA Open House.

Our contemporary understanding of exploring and displaying new ideas and concepts of architecture has become familiar through the rise of architectural biennials like the Venice Biennale or the Chicago Architecture Biennial. But the display of architecture has not always existed in its current format rather it has evolved from a lineage tied to the exhibit of art. To adequately curate and organize IIT's Open House, we must also understand a longer history of exhibition. While this studio will not be an exhaustive history of exhibition design, we will attempt to trace the lineage of exhibitions from the Academy, Salons, World's Fair, International Art Exhibitions and Fairs to contemporary Biennials and institutionalized museums as context for discussion and generation of ideas for the 2025 IIT CoA Open House. These discussions will include guest lectures from curators and architects using exhibitions and installations as an approach to explore, experiment and express facets of architecture in a critical forum.

Adjacent to this learning, we will begin to plan and formulate ideas for the exhibition of student work. This will involve not just developing a theme for Open House, but also managing and fabricating and installing a center core installation that captures the thematic approach of the show. The seminar will submit proposals for the theme and design that will include detailed information about schedule, materials, process and details of fabrication, and cost. Proposals will be critiqued and vetted by a select faculty, an outside jury and the Dean of our college with the potential that one or a combination of proposals will be used for the final center core installation. Installation will be focused on Center Core only though proposals may include ideas for other Crown Hall spaces.

The latter half of the semester will involve the actual fabrication and installation of all components needed for the selected Center Core installation including graphic design for printed or digital media. The studio will also produce fabrication drawings and presentation diagrams for exhibition descriptions and brochures.

This studio will require time in the shop handling large materials and working in teams to complete allocated tasks. ***The majority of installation work will occur during finals weeks, thus, only students willing to allocate a minimum of 25 hours in the week leading up to Open House (May 5 - May 9) and those comfortable with shop tools and fabrication should register for this course. Though a small team will be dedicated to graphics.***

***** Chicago Architecture Biennial – September 12, 2025 – February 28, 2026***

Approach

The seminar follows 2 paths:

- 1) Tracing histories and learning from contemporary curators
- 2) Developing and fabricating the 2024 Open House exhibition

Phase 1

- Tracing the Lineage of Exhibitions

Phase 2

- Open House Exhibition Proposal

Phase 2.1

- Proposal Refinement and Allocation of Task

Phase 3

- Mock-up and Fabrication of Materials

Phase 4

- Open House Installation (May 5 - May 9)
- IIT Open House Opening: Friday, May 9

Course Details

Advanced Studio ARCH 420_546: The Architecture of Exhibitions and Installations

6 Credit Units (eligible for design-build credits)

M/W/F 2:00 pm to 6:00 pm

Studio Location: Crown Hall

College of Architecture, Illinois Institute of Technology

Faculty:

Prof. Jennifer Park, jpark14@iit.edu

Teaching Assistants:

Reilly Kenney, rkenney@hawk.iit.edu

Roshan Patel, rpatel197@hawk.iit.edu

Chloe Chukwunyelum, mchukwunyelum@hawk.iit.edu

Schedule

2025 Spring Overview

Wednesday, January 13: Class Introduction

Monday, January 20: MLK Day – NO CLASS

Friday, January 25: Drop/Add Ends

Week of February 28: Proposal Presentations

Wednesday, March 17-22: Spring Break

Friday, March 31: Last Day to Withdraw

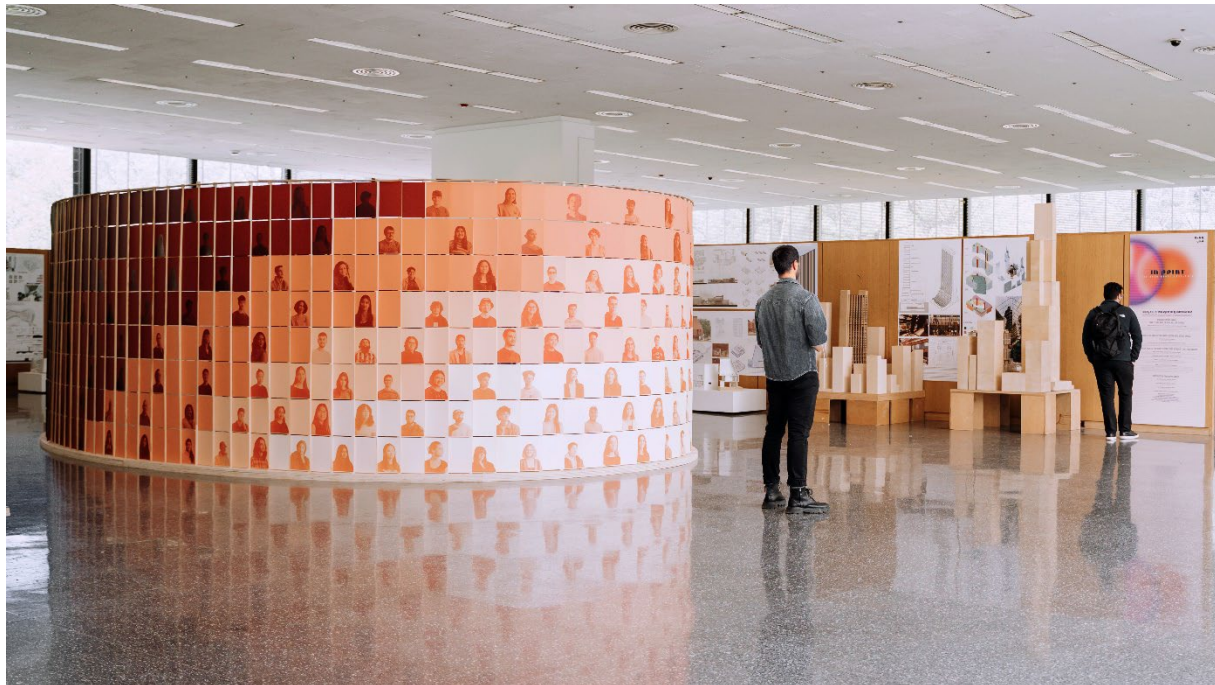
Week of April 28: Final Presentations for Advance Studio

Friday, May 3: Last Day of Classes

May 3 – May 9: Final Exam Week (Open House Installation)

Friday, May 9: IIT Open House

Wednesday, May 14: Final Grades Due (Noon)



IIT Open House “Im/Print” Center Core Installation, May 2024

Course Expectations

This seminar requires students to engage the historical, conceptual and constructable in order to demonstrate an understanding of the framework behind exhibitions and installations.

In order to do this, students will be tasked to exhibit the following criteria:

- 1) Critical thinking – conversations and discussions presented for this seminar are not simply to be digested, but to be questioned, speculated and rationalized. Critical thinking is self-guided, self-disciplined thinking which attempts to reason at the highest level of quality in a fair-minded way. A critical thinker:
 - a. raises vital questions and problems, formulating them clearly and precisely;
 - b. gathers and assesses relevant information, using abstract ideas to interpret it effectively comes to well-reasoned conclusions and solutions, testing them against relevant criteria and standards;
 - c. thinks open mindedly within alternative systems of thought, recognizing and assessing, as need be, their assumptions, implications, and practical consequences; and
 - d. communicates effectively with others in figuring out solutions to complex problems.
- 2) Conceptual thinking – the ability to analyze hypothetical situations or abstract concepts to apply insight; the ability to understand a situation or problem by identifying patterns or connections.
- 3) Craft and Construction – This seminar will require a high level of craft and attention to detail as we fabricate, and construct exhibits armatures. Attention to details in construction will be closely analyzed and critiqued for quality and execution.
- 4) Collaborative and conversational – many of the exercises in this seminar will be done in groups. This requires students to work together and work through ideas to find a presentable solution. Teamwork is essential; each student has a shared responsibility to their group. This seminar will also require students to engage in meaningful conversations on related readings and lectures. This seminar should be a comfortable atmosphere for discussions or debates.
- 5) Intensity and rigor – The intensity and rigor towards one's work will be exhibited in the quality of written, drawn and built work which requires time, effort, focus and diligence.
- 6) Verbal and visual articulation – articulation of concepts and ideas should be understood and clarified prior to any presentation either as a desk-crit or a final review. Rehearsal of verbal presentations should be done prior to any major review. Drafts of visual presentations should be checked (spell-check/pixilation/color saturation, etc.) prior to any pin-up.

Other requirements of this seminar are attendance and punctuality, delivery of work for presentations, pin-up, assignments, and respect for classmates, professors, seminar space and institution. Late assignments without a valid excuse will result in a loss of one letter grade for each day of lateness.

The primary means of communication for the studio will be email and One Drive. Lectures will be recorded and posted for viewing outside of class. In addition, we require each group and/or individual student to provide us with a digital copy of your work as it develops and in its final format. Digital copies of work will be collected via the One Drive.

Attendance

Attendance is mandatory at all course meetings (including any classes meeting in the field) for the full duration of the session. **You are expected to arrive on time and to remain in class for the duration of the course period.** The course period is intended for in-studio work related to this studio only. Students may not work on other courses during class time, and may only leave class with the permission of their instructor. **Students may not listen or watch non-seminar related media.** Students will refrain from using non-studio related electronic communications during studio time such as cell phone calls, text messaging, email, etc. **Failure to comply with these requirements constitutes an unexcused absence.**

Absences can be excused if: 1) they result from a death in the student's immediate family, 2) they are caused by illness (must be followed up with a note from your physician), or 3) they are approved in advance at the discretion of your studio instructor. Two unexcused/unapproved absences will result in an Academic Early Warning report and more than three **unexcused/unapproved absences will result as a one full grade reduction. Each unexcused absence thereafter will continue to be reduced by one full grade.** Unexcused late arrivals or early departures will be counted as unexcused absences.

All assignments, including the final submission, must be handed in complete and on time. Work submitted late or in an incomplete state will either be penalized during grading, or not accepted as determined by the professor.

Computer issues and output problems will not be accepted as a valid excuse for failure to submit work or to pin-up. Failure to present work at any of the project reviews will result in an Academic Early Warning report and failure to present in more than one project review will result in failure for the course or being withdrawn. Absence from a review is equivalent to absence from an exam. **Anyone arriving late or arriving without complete work for scheduled pin-ups or critiques will be marked absent and will not be allowed to present.**

Attendance policy as outlined by IIT are as follows:

All students are expected to attend classes regularly. Excessive absences may be grounds for a failing grade. Non-attendance does not constitute an official withdrawal. When illness or emergency requires a student to miss more than two days of class, the student must notify the course instructor. It is also recommended that the student contact the dean of students and the director of undergraduate advising. It may be necessary to provide written documentation of the reason for the absences. Faculty members determine their own policies for attendance and make-up work.

Consideration for the specific accommodations cannot be recognized without the actual letter, schedule and/or consent from the department head or coach. Accommodations can include: Accommodation letters from Center for Disabilities, athlete schedules and early dismissal forms, or student organizations approved events.

Grading

Grades are established to meet or exceed the course requirements. In summary, studio grades will be based on an evaluation of the following:

- (1) Critical and conceptual thinking: your comprehension of the content the studio objectives as evidenced in the technical proficiency, craft of your work and design concept, and engagement in discussion over readings and lectures.
- (2) Design Development: the quality, consistency, intensity and depth of your work, and your level of investigation and development in the refinement of your ideas/projects, and on-time submission of work per assignment due dates
- (3) Craft and Articulation – quality of work and attention to detail in all visual mediums; ability to describe and explain concepts and development of work in a clear and concise manner
- (4) Attendance and Participation: student-instructor dialogue, participation in class-wide critiques and discussion; attention in final reviews; teamwork with group activities. Teammates may be asked to rate your efforts and participation.

Other factors contributing to grading include daily progress and ability to manage time. Computer issues and output problems will not be accepted as a valid excuse for failure to submit work or to pin-up.

Grades will follow the official IIT University grading policy. Letter grades are defined specifically as follows:

Incomplete (I): Only for extenuating circumstances which impede your ability to deliver your work complete and on time. Must be approved by the professor in advance of final grading.

Failing (E): Work fails to meet the minimum course requirements for completeness and/or comprehension. Late, incomplete, failing, or work not submitted.

Below Average (D): Assignments are incomplete and/or of low quality and craft. Very inconsistent or little to no effort is exhibited. Very little development and meeting few course objectives. Shows lack of commitment to the course.

Average (C): Completes all assignments with work of acceptable quality and craft, but with little distinction. Minimum requirements met on time, and course objectives are met. Minimal participation. Needs improvement in work habits and critical thinking skills.

Above Average (B): Completes all assignments with work of high quality and craft. Exhibits significant levels of development and progress with work, and meets all course objectives. Most work of high quality, energy and participation. Shows ability in basic critical thinking.

Excellent (A): Consistently produces work of the highest level of quality and craft, and exhibits technical proficiency and comprehension with distinction. All course objectives are exceeded. Work of excellent quality, energy and intense involvement. Demonstrates capacity to be self-critical.

Other Policies and Resources

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) Policy Statement:

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) Policy Statement: Reasonable accommodations will be made for students with documented disabilities. In order to receive accommodations, students must go through the Center for Disability Resources office. The Center for Disability Resources (CDR) is located in the Life Sciences Room 218, telephone 312-567-5744 or disabilities@iit.edu.

Academic Code of Honesty

Illinois Tech expects students to maintain high standards of academic integrity. Students preparing for the practice of a profession are expected to conform to a code of integrity and ethical standards commensurate with the high expectations society places upon the practitioners of a learned profession. No student may seek to gain an unfair advantage over another.

It shall be a violation of this Code of Academic Honesty for a student to engage in conduct that violates the established standards of his or her major academic discipline, the established standards of the academic discipline in which she or he is engaged, the established standards of the profession of which she or he is training, or the standards of Illinois Tech set forth herein. In addition, it is a violation of this Code of Academic Honesty for a student, whether or not currently enrolled at Illinois Tech, knowingly to engage or attempt to engage in the following or to engage or attempt to engage in a course of action that would cause a reasonable student to conclude a violation of any of the following would be the likely result:

- ***The misrepresentation of any work submitted for credit or otherwise as the product of a student's sole independent effort, such as using the ideas of others without attribution and other forms of plagiarism;***
- The use of any unauthorized assistance in taking quizzes, tests or examinations;
- The acquisition, without permission, of tests, answers sheets, problem solutions or other academic material when such material has been withheld from distribution by the instructor;
- Deliberate and harmful obstruction of the studies, research or academic work of any member of the Illinois Tech community;
- Making a material misrepresentation in any submission to or through any office of Illinois Tech to a potential employer, agency, professional society, meeting, or organization; or
- The intentional assistance of others in violation of the standards set forth in this Code of Academic Honesty.

For more information regarding Academic Policies and Codes of Conduct, refer to the Student Handbook:

<https://web.iit.edu/student-affairs/handbook/fine-print/code-academic-honesty>

https://web.iit.edu/sites/web/files/departments/student-affairs/pdfs/HANDBOOK_17-18.pdf

Academic Honesty in Architectural Design

The design process often involves research and knowledge of past precedents of design work for context. We often refer to the work of others for inspiration or insights that might help to inform our own work. However, the design process also depends on independent thinking and a demonstration of one's own creative ideas. It is important that the ideas and the design process are original to the creator and not adopted from another source or represented as one's own. This misrepresentation of design work violates the IIT Code of Academic Honesty (see Other Policies section of Syllabus).

This code specifically outlines that a violation would be considered:

- 1. The misrepresentation of any work submitted for credit or otherwise as other than the product of a student's sole independent effort, such as using the ideas of others without attribution and other forms of plagiarism;***

Examples of this violation would be copying and pasting images from the internet (with or without additional without photoshopping) and claiming work as one's own or part of one's personal design; copying the design of built work or other research from the internet; copying another student's work or drawings for independent or individual work. If you are unsure if you are crossing the lines of plagiarism, please reach out to your instructor for guidance.

For more information regarding Academic Policies and Codes of Conduct, refer to the Student Handbook:

<https://web.iit.edu/student-affairs/handbook/fine-print/code-academic-honesty>

https://web.iit.edu/sites/web/files/departments/student-affairs/pdfs/HANDBOOK_17-18.pdf

Academic Resource Center (ARC):

Hermann Hall for help with study or language skills. <http://iit.edu/arc/>

IIT Writing Center:

One-to-one help with writing assignments. <https://www.iit.edu/cac/writing-guides/help-writing-assignments>

Student Health and Wellness Center:

Provides health care, advocacy, wellness resources student.health@iit.edu

Therapy/Psychiatric Counseling:

<https://www.iit.edu/shwc/appointments/counseling-appointments>

Code of Academic Honesty:

<https://web.iit.edu/student-affairs/handbook/fine-print/code-academic-honesty>

Student Code of Conduct:

https://webmaster.iit.edu/files/general-counsel/faculty-handbook/code_of_conduct.pdf

Studio Culture:

<https://arch.iit.edu/about/studio-culture>

COVID-19 Precautions and Guidelines:

iit.edu/COVID-19